KASTRA POS

User Guide

KASTRA Technologies

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Contents

KASTRA POS — User Guide **3**
Contents . . . 3

Getting going **4**
1. Who does what . . . 4
2. Signing in . . . 4
3. Your first sale in 60 seconds . . . 5

Selling **6**
4. The POS screen . . . 6
5. Adding items to the cart . . . 6
6. Taking payment . . . 7
7. Receipts . . . 7
8. Holding and recalling a sale . . . 8
9. Fixing mistakes: cart edit, void, refund . . . 8
10. Customers, credit and loyalty . . . 8

Your kind of business **9**
11. Restaurant, café and bar . . . 9
12. Hotel . . . 9
13. Pharmacy . . . 9
14. Fuel station, cyber café and other trades . . . 10

Stock and suppliers **11**
15. Stock, receiving and counting . . . 11
16. Expiry dates and batches . . . 11
17. Suppliers and purchase orders . . . 11

Money **13**
18. Cash drawer, shifts and closing the day . . . 13
19. Expenses and the books . . . 13
20. Reports worth knowing . . . 13
21. KRA, VAT and eTIMS . . . 14

Beyond the counter **15**
22. Selling online and to customers' phones . . . 15
23. Delivery . . . 15
24. Field sales and B2B invoicing . . . 15
25. Staff, leave and payroll . . . 16
26. The mobile apps . . . 16

Running the shop **17**
27. Settings you will actually use 17
28. Your plan and what it unlocks 17
29. Working offline 18
30. When something goes wrong 18
31. Quick reference card 19
32. Glossary 19

KASTRA POS — User Guide

This guide is for the people who use KASTRA POS to run a business. Owners, managers, cashiers, waiters, kitchen staff and accountants.

You do not need to understand servers, databases or code to read it. If you are installing KASTRA on a server, you want the **Admin & Installation Guide** instead.

Everything here is written as a task: *how do I take a sale*, *how do I refund someone*, *how do I close the day*. Find your task, follow the steps.

Contents

Getting going 1. Who does what 2. Signing in 3. Your first sale in 60 seconds

Selling 4. The POS screen 5. Adding items to the cart 6. Taking payment 7. Receipts 8. Holding and recalling a sale 9. Fixing mistakes: cart edit, void, refund 10. Customers, credit and loyalty

Your kind of business 11. Restaurant, café and bar 12. Hotel 13. Pharmacy 14. Fuel station, cyber café and other trades

Stock and suppliers 15. Stock, receiving and counting 16. Expiry dates and batches 17. Suppliers and purchase orders

Money 18. Cash drawer, shifts and closing the day 19. Expenses and the books 20. Reports worth knowing 21. KRA, VAT and eTIMS

Beyond the counter 22. Selling online and to customers' phones 23. Delivery 24. Field sales and B2B invoicing 25. Staff, leave and payroll 26. The mobile apps

Running the shop 27. Settings you will actually use 28. Your plan and what it unlocks 29. Working offline 30. When something goes wrong 31. Quick reference card 32. Glossary

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Getting going

1. Who does what

KASTRA gives each person only what their job needs. If a screen described in this guide is missing for you, it is almost certainly your role — ask the owner.

Role	What they can do
Owner	Everything, including settings, staff and billing
Manager	Sell, manage stock, approve things, see reports, authorise voids
Cashier	Sell, look up and create customers, manage **their own** cash drawer, see **their own** sales
Waiter	Take table orders, print bills. **Cannot take payment or see reports**
Kitchen	See the kitchen screen and mark items in-progress or ready. Sees no money at all
Accountant	Reports, expenses, ledger, supplier accounts. **Cannot sell or edit stock**

Two deliberate choices worth knowing:

- A **cashier cannot browse other cashiers' takings.** The sales list shows only their own. Owners, managers and accountants see everything.
- An **accountant can see the money but cannot touch stock or staff.** Approving spending is a management act, not an accounting one.

Owners can also build **custom roles** in Settings if these six do not fit.

2. Signing in

There are two ways in, and they behave differently on purpose.

Email and password — for office work. Your session lasts **15 minutes** of inactivity before it needs refreshing. This is the secure option for anything involving money, staff or settings.

PIN — for the shop floor. Four to six digits, and the session lasts **12 hours**, so a cashier is not retyping a password all shift. Tap your name, enter your PIN.

Owners may also enable:

- **Google sign-in**
- **Two-factor (TOTP)** — an authenticator app code on top of your password. Recommended for owners, and often required

- **Fingerprint / face unlock** where the device supports it

  "No sales found" when you know there are sales? Your session quietly expired. Sign in again. If it keeps happening on a shared shop-floor device, ask the owner to switch that device to PIN login.

3. Your first sale in 60 seconds

1. Open **POS**.
2. Type the first few letters of the item, or scan its barcode.
3. Click the item. It lands in the cart on the right.
4. Click **Charge** (or press **F1** for a straight cash sale).
5. Pick how the customer is paying.
6. Enter what they handed over. KASTRA shows the change.
7. **Complete**. The receipt prints or sends.

That is the whole loop. Everything below is detail on top of it.

Selling

4. The POS screen

Three areas:

- **Left / centre — the item grid.** Your products, grouped by category. Tap to add.
- **Top — the search bar.** Typing here searches names, SKUs and barcodes.
- **Right — the cart.** Lines, quantities, discounts, the running total, and the **Charge** button.

Keyboard shortcuts (they work when you are not typing in a box):

Key	Does
`/`	Jump to search
`F1`	Charge as cash
`F5`	Hold the current sale
`F6`	Recall a held sale

The screen adapts to your business type. A restaurant asks which table first; a fuel station asks which pump; a supermarket runs a denser, scan-heavy layout. Same cart underneath.

5. Adding items to the cart

Search — type any part of the name, the SKU, or the barcode.

Scan — use a USB/Bluetooth scanner, or the camera. A scanner just types into the search box, so it works anywhere the box is focused.

Quick price entry — type `3x500` and press Enter to add **three of the item that costs KES 500**. `3x500` and `3*500` work too. This is built for market stalls and kiosks where staff know goods by price rather than name. Note it matches on **price, not quantity of shillings** — if two items both cost 500, it takes the first.

Weighed goods — scan the label a weighing scale prints (a GS1 barcode). KASTRA reads the weight, subtracts the **tare** (the container's own weight, set per item), and prices the net. A toast confirms: *"Scanned: Beef — Net: 1.240 kg (tare: 0.010 kg deducted)"*.

Price levels — retail and wholesale. Switch the level on the cart before charging and every line reprices.

Overriding a price — allowed if your role permits it, and it is recorded against your name.

Two things may interrupt you, by design:

- **Age gate** — for age-restricted goods, KASTRA asks you to confirm the customer's age before the line is added.
- **Expiry warning** — if stock about to be sold is expired or close to it, KASTRA stops and shows you which batch. See section 16.

6. Taking payment

Click **Charge**. The payment window offers:

Method	Notes
Cash	Type what the customer handed over; change is calculated
M-Pesa — STK Push	Sends the prompt to the customer's phone. They enter their PIN
M-Pesa — QR Code	Shows a QR on screen for the customer to scan
M-Pesa — Paybill / Till	For manual paybill payments; enter the reference
Card — Paystack	Card payment through Paystack
Card — Terminal	A connected card terminal (Ingenico, PAX, Verifone)
NFC	Tap-to-pay where supported
Bank Transfer	Records bank, account name, branch and reference
Credit Sale	Puts it on the customer's account. Needs a customer, and respects their credit limit
Gift Card	Scan or type the card code; shows the remaining balance
Room Charge	Hotel mode — bills it to a guest's room folio
Split Pay	Any combination of the above

Split payments are the common real-world case: KES 1,000 in cash and the rest on M-Pesa. Choose **Split Pay**, add each part, and KASTRA tracks *Remaining to pay* until it reaches zero.

On credit sales, if the amount would push the customer past their limit, KASTRA blocks it and says *"Credit limit exceeded"*. A manager can raise the limit on the customer's record.

On M-Pesa STK, the screen shows *"Waiting for payment"* while the customer approves on their phone. Do not hand over goods until it confirms. If they never respond it times out and you can retry or switch method.

7. Receipts

After a sale you can:

- **Print** to a thermal receipt printer
- **Send by SMS or WhatsApp** — automatic when the sale has a customer with a phone number
- **Email** it
- Show a **digital receipt** on screen for the customer to photograph
- Print an **A4 invoice** instead of a receipt, for business customers

You can customise the header, footer, logo and wording in **Settings -> Receipt**.

8. Holding and recalling a sale

A customer forgot their wallet and is going to the car. Do not cancel the sale.

- **F5** or **Hold** parks the cart under a name or number.
- **F6** or **Recall** brings it back.

The till is free for the next customer in between. Held sales are not sales yet — nothing has been recorded and no stock has moved.

9. Fixing mistakes: cart edit, void, refund

This is the section worth reading twice, because the three are genuinely different and KASTRA treats them differently on purpose.

Before payment — just edit the cart

Remove the line, change the quantity, start over. Nothing has happened yet: no receipt, no stock movement, no record. **No manager, no reason, no audit trail.**

After payment — void

The receipt exists, so undoing it is a formal act.

- Requires a **manager PIN** and a **written reason**
- Either **the whole sale** or **specific lines**
- Writes a permanent entry to the audit log that nobody can edit or delete
- **Puts the stock back**
- Sends a **void or amendment to KRA** through eTIMS

Use a void when the sale should never have happened — wrong item rung up, duplicate charge, customer changed their mind at the counter.

Later — refund / return

The customer comes back tomorrow with the goods. Use **Return** from the sale in the sales list. Stock comes back in, the money goes out, and the return is linked to the original sale.

> **Rule of thumb:** cart edit = nothing happened. Void = it happened and we are cancelling it. Return = it happened, it stood, and now goods are coming back.

10. Customers, credit and loyalty

Add a customer from the POS or from **Customers**. Useful fields: phone (drives SMS and WhatsApp receipts), KRA PIN (needed on B2B invoices), and **credit limit**.

Credit / account sales — sell now, collect later. The customer's outstanding balance shows on their record and in the **Credit Book** report. Record payments against the account as they come in.

Loyalty — customers earn points on qualifying sales and redeem them as payment. Set the earn and redeem rates in Settings.

Gift cards — sell them, check balances, redeem them at the till.

Your kind of business

KASTRA runs one till that changes shape depending on your business type. Set it in **Settings -> Business type**.

11. Restaurant, café and bar

Tables. The floor plan shows your tables grouped by area. Tap a table to start or continue its order. Tables can be **merged**, **transferred** to another table, and **split** for separate bills.

The order is not a sale. Food goes to the kitchen long before anyone pays. KASTRA keeps *orders* (what the kitchen is making) separate from *sales* (money that changed hands). The order becomes a sale when the bill is settled.

Kitchen tickets (KOT). When you send an order, each line goes to the right printer automatically — food to the kitchen, drinks to the bar. You set that routing once, per category.

Kitchen display (KDS). Instead of paper, the kitchen can run a screen showing live orders. Kitchen staff tap to mark items *in progress* and *ready*. Waiters see the status without walking to the pass.

Modifiers. "No onions", "extra shot", "well done" — and they can carry a price.

Bar tabs. Open a tab against a customer or a name, keep adding to it, settle at the end of the night.

Service charge. Applied automatically at your configured rate.

Reservations and the waitlist. Take bookings ahead of time, and manage walk-ins waiting for a table.

12. Hotel

- **Rooms** — availability, rates, status
- **Bookings** — check guests in and out
- **Guest folio** — everything the guest charges during their stay, on one bill
- **Room charge** — the restaurant and bar can bill straight to a room
- **Housekeeping** — a live queue of rooms needing service
- **Channel manager** — keeps availability in step with booking sites

13. Pharmacy

- **Prescriptions** captured at the till against the patient
- **Batch and expiry tracking** enforced — see section 16
- Controlled items flagged and recorded

14. Fuel station, cyber café and other trades

- **Fuel station** — authorise a pump, sell the fuel it dispensed, close the pump
- **Cyber café** — start and stop timed sessions per station, bill the time. Stations are counter-managed on the web app
- **Salon / clinic** — an appointment diary with bookings against staff
- **Supermarket** — a denser, faster scan-first layout built for queues

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Stock and suppliers

15. Stock, receiving and counting

Stock is never simply typed in. Every change is a recorded movement with a reason: a sale, a return, a delivery received, a transfer, a count adjustment, a write-off. That is why you can always answer *"where did those twelve go?"*.

Adding items — one at a time in **Inventory**, or in bulk by **CSV import**. Items can have **variants** (size, colour, weight) and be sold as **bundles** or made from a **recipe**.

Receiving stock — raise a purchase order, then receive against it (a GRN). What you actually received is recorded, so short deliveries show up in the **GRN Discrepancy** report rather than quietly vanishing.

Stocktake — open a stocktake session, count, and enter counts. KASTRA shows counted against expected, you review the variance, then commit. The adjustment is recorded with your name on it.

Transfers — move stock between stores. The sending store loses it and the receiving store gains it, with the movement recorded both ends.

Damaged goods — write off breakages and spoilage with a reason, so shrinkage is measured rather than guessed.

Barcode labels — generate and print labels for items and shelf edges.

16. Expiry dates and batches

If you sell food, medicine or anything else that goes off, turn on batch tracking for those items.

- Stock is received in **batches**, each with its own expiry date
- KASTRA sells **oldest-first (FEFO)** automatically — first expired, first out
- You get **expiry alerts** ahead of time so stock can be moved or discounted
- If someone tries to sell expired stock, the till **stops them** and names the batch
- A **recall** can pull a whole batch, and tell you which customers bought from it

Serial numbers are the same idea for individually-tracked goods — electronics, appliances — where you need to know exactly which unit went to which customer.

17. Suppliers and purchase orders

- **Suppliers** — contacts, terms, and what you owe them
- **Purchase orders** — raise, send, and track them
- **Goods received (GRN)** — record what actually arrived

- **RFQ** — ask several suppliers to quote, compare, and pick. Suppliers respond through a link you send them; they do not need a login
- **Supplier ageing** — what you owe, by how overdue it is

Money

18. Cash drawer, shifts and closing the day

Opening. Declare your opening float when you start.

During the shift. Record cash paid in and out (a supplier paid in cash, a staff advance) so the drawer stays explainable.

X-report. A mid-shift snapshot. Read it any time; it changes nothing.

Z-report. The end-of-day close. It totals the day, closes it off, and is the number your books are built on.

Counting down. Enter what is physically in the drawer. KASTRA shows the difference against what it expected — over, under, or exact. Differences are recorded, which is the point.

19. Expenses and the books

- **Expenses** — record what the business spends, by category, with approval where you require it
- **Cheques** — track cheques in and out and when they clear
- **Ledger** — the underlying accounts
- **Reconciliation** — match your records against the bank and M-Pesa statements
- **Budgets** — set them and track against them

20. Reports worth knowing

There are 44 report tabs across six groups. These are the ones most businesses live on:

Report	Answers
X / Z Report	What happened today, and closing it off
Sales	What sold, when, by whom
Gross Margin	What you actually made, not just turnover
P & L	Profit and loss for the period
Dead Stock	What has not moved and is tying up cash
Shrinkage	What went missing
Credit Book	Who owes you
Supplier Ageing	Who you owe
Sales by Staff	Who is selling
Item Summary	Per-item performance
Basket Analysis	What gets bought together
Customer LTV	What a customer is worth over time

Report	Answers
VAT Return	Your VAT position
Audit Log	Who did what, tamper-evident

Every tab exports to **CSV**. VAT reports, receipts, purchase orders and B2B invoices also export to **PDF**. Reports can be **scheduled** to email themselves to you.

Forecasting predicts demand from your sales history so you order better.

21. KRA, VAT and eTIMS

KASTRA is built for Kenyan tax compliance.

- **VAT is inclusive.** The price on the shelf is what the customer pays; KASTRA extracts the VAT within it. It does not add VAT on top at the till.
- **TOT** (turnover tax) is supported for businesses not on VAT.
- **eTIMS** — sales are submitted to KRA automatically after checkout. Voids and amendments go too.
- **Offline** — if KRA is unreachable, submissions queue and go when the connection returns. You keep trading.
- **KRA export** — produce the files KRA asks for.
- **Audit log** — tamper-evident, and exportable.

Your KRA credentials are entered once in **Settings -> eTIMS** and stored encrypted. Start in **test** mode; switch to **production** once KRA approves you.

Beyond the counter

22. Selling online and to customers' phones

Each of these is a link you can print, share or turn into a QR code. **None of them require the customer to install anything.**

What	Link	For
Web storefront	`/shop/<your business>`	Browsing and ordering online
QR menu	`/menu/<your business>`	Table menus in a restaurant
Online ordering	`/order/<your business>`	Takeaway and delivery orders
Payment link	`/pay/<code>`	Send someone a link to pay you
Order tracking	`/track/<order number>`	Customer follows their delivery
Customer portal	`/portal`	Customers sign in with a phone code to see orders, points and account

Orders placed through these arrive in **Online Orders** for you to accept and fulfil.

23. Delivery

- Take delivery orders from the shop, the storefront or the phone apps
- Assign a **driver**
- The customer gets a **tracking link** showing the driver's live position
- Drivers confirm delivery on their phone, with proof
- **Delivery routes** plan a driver's whole run rather than one drop at a time

24. Field sales and B2B invoicing

For businesses that sell out of a van or through agents on the road.

The agent, on their phone: - Sees a **call plan** — which shops to visit, prioritised by who owes the most - Registers new shops, with GPS - Takes orders against a shop's credit limit - Collects payments and records them - Works with no signal — everything queues and syncs later

The office, on the web: - Orders arrive on the **Field Orders** board - **Generate Invoice** for the full order, or **Partial Invoice** for only what was actually delivered - **Invoice All Delivered** does the whole day's delivered orders at once - **Record Payment** — cash, M-Pesa, bank or cheque - The customer is notified by WhatsApp or SMS automatically - **B2B Invoice PDF**

with your letterhead, itemised lines, payment terms and bank details - **Invoice Ageing** buckets what is outstanding: 0–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+ days

You can also save a POS cart as a **proforma invoice** rather than a sale — useful when a business customer needs a quote before they will pay.

25. Staff, leave and payroll

- **Staff records**, roles and pay rates
- **Commission** — by sales value, transaction count, or gross margin
- **Leave** with running balances
- **Shift scheduling**, plus sales per shift
- **Attendance**
- **Disciplinary records** and **salary advances**
- **Payroll** — Kenyan PAYE, **SHIF**, NSSF and the Affordable Housing Levy
- **Payslips** generated per employee

  Payroll follows the **SHIF** rules that replaced NHIF. Older payslips keep the figures they were generated with.

26. The mobile apps

Four separate Android apps, each for one job.

App	Who	What it does
KASTRA POS	Cashiers, managers	A full till in your hand, plus a Manage section for stock, counts, transfers, approvals and day-close
KASTRA Order	Your customers	Browse the menu, order, pay by M-Pesa, book a table, check points
KASTRA Driver	Drivers	Assigned drops, navigation hand-off, delivery confirmation, earnings
KASTRA Agent	Field sales agents	Call plan, orders, collections, new shop registration

All four work offline and sync when signal returns.

Pointing an app at your server: on the login screen, set the server address. Your installer will give you this. It defaults to the cloud service.

Receipt printing on mobile is off by default, because most mobile selling has no printer and sends the receipt by SMS or WhatsApp instead. Turn it on in the app's Settings and a Print button appears after each sale. It prints through the phone's own print system, so it works with a printer already paired to the phone, or saves a PDF.

Running the shop

27. Settings you will actually use

Setting	Why you would touch it
Business type	Changes the whole till — restaurant, retail, fuel, pharmacy…
Receipt	Logo, header, footer wording
Tax	VAT or TOT, and your rate
eTIMS	KRA credentials, test or production
Payments	M-Pesa, Paystack, bank details
Users	Add staff, set roles and PINs
Stores	Multiple branches
Printers	Which printer gets food, which gets drinks
Loyalty	Earn and redeem rates
Security	Two-factor, password rules, lockouts

28. Your plan and what it unlocks

Plan	KES/month	Stores	Users
Free	0	1	1
Starter	999	1	8
Growth	2,499	2	15
Pro	4,999	5	30
Enterprise	14,999	Unlimited	Unlimited

Roughly what each adds:

- **Free** — the till, stock, customers, sales list, cash drawer
- **Starter** — reports, batch tracking, receipt customisation
- **Growth** — restaurant and bar, kitchen screen, pharmacy, delivery, suppliers, promotions, gift cards, stocktake
- **Pro** — multi-store transfers, owner dashboard, HR and payroll, ledger, reconciliation, API keys, scheduled reports
- **Enterprise** — field sales, delivery routes, hotel, channel manager, forecasting, franchise

During your trial you get everything, so you can see what you actually need. When the trial ends, your plan's features apply.

If a menu item is missing, it is on a higher plan. Clicking it explains which.

Referring other businesses

If you recommend KASTRA to another business and they sign up, you earn a reward through the **referral programme**. Your referral link is in Settings.

There is also a separate **affiliate programme** for people who promote KASTRA commercially and earn ongoing commission — you do not need to be a KASTRA customer to join it. Affiliates get their own sign-in at `/affiliate`, which is separate from your POS login and gives no access to any business's data.

29. Working offline

KASTRA is built to keep selling when the internet does not.

What still works offline: taking sales, printing receipts, looking up cached items and customers.

What happens to those sales: they are saved on the device and sent up when the connection returns. Each one carries a unique ID, so a sale that was actually received before the connection dropped is **never charged twice** on retry.

What you will see: a sync indicator showing how many are waiting.

What does not work offline: anything that needs a live third party — M-Pesa STK, card payments, and live KRA submission. eTIMS submissions queue and go later.

> **On the mobile cashier app**, the offline queue is flushed from the **Sync** button in Settings. If you have been selling offline, open Settings and tap Sync once you are back on signal.

30. When something goes wrong

"No sales found" but there are sales Your session expired. Sign in again.

A menu item disappeared Either your role does not include it, or it is on a higher plan.

M-Pesa says "waiting for payment" forever The customer never approved it on their phone. Cancel and retry, or take another payment method. Never hand over goods on an unconfirmed STK.

"Credit limit exceeded" The sale would put the customer past their limit. A manager can raise it on the customer's record, or take part payment now.

The receipt printer does nothing Check power and cable first, then that the right printer is selected in Settings. For kitchen tickets, check the category is routed to that printer.

Stock looks wrong Open the item's movement history. Every change is listed with a reason and a name.

Expired-stock warning I need to get past That is deliberate. Check the batch. If it genuinely is fine, a manager can resolve it — but the warning is there because selling expired goods is a real liability.

Sales are not reaching KRA Check the eTIMS status in Settings. If the queue is backing up, your credentials or connection need attention — tell whoever runs your server.

The app is slow or behaving oddly Refresh the page. If it persists on one device only, that device is the problem, not the system.

31. Quick reference card

Keyboard

Key	Action
`/`	Search
`F1`	Cash sale
`F5`	Hold sale
`F6`	Recall held sale

Quick entry

Type	Result
`3x500`	Three of the item priced KES 500
Scan a scale label	Weighed item, tare deducted

The three ways to undo

Situation	Do this	Needs
Not paid yet	Edit the cart	Nothing
Paid, cancel it	**Void**	Manager PIN + reason
Paid, goods coming back	**Return**	Per your settings

Daily rhythm

1. Sign in, declare your float
2. Sell
3. X-report to check mid-shift
4. Count the drawer
5. **Z-report** to close the day

32. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Batch / lot	A delivery of stock with its own expiry date
eTIMS	KRA's electronic tax invoice system
FEFO	First Expired, First Out — oldest stock sells first
Folio	A hotel guest's running bill
GRN	Goods Received Note — what actually arrived
KOT	Kitchen Order Ticket
KDS	Kitchen Display Screen
Layaway	Customer pays in instalments; goods held until paid
PAYE	Kenyan income tax deducted from salaries
Proforma	A quote — looks like an invoice, is not a sale
RFQ	Request for Quotation — ask suppliers to bid

Term	Meaning
SHIF	Social Health Insurance Fund, replaced NHIF
STK push	The M-Pesa prompt that appears on a customer's phone
Shrinkage	Stock lost to theft, damage or error
Tare	The container's own weight, deducted from weighed goods
TOT	Turnover Tax, for businesses not registered for VAT
VSCU	The offline eTIMS queue that holds sales until KRA is reachable
X / Z report	Mid-shift snapshot / end-of-day close

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*Need the installation and server side instead? See the **Admin & Installation Guide**.*